School Election: Vote by Link

A simple way to run your election. Students get one link and their own code, and vote once for each office on any phone, tablet or computer.

Before voting

1. **Set up the election.** Go to **Schools** and choose **Set up a school election**. Add each office (for example President, Vice President) and its candidates. Tick **Vote by link**. You can tick it later from the election page too.
2. **Add your students.** On the election page, find **Roster and turnout**. Type or paste one student per line: *Name*, or *Name, Student ID*, or *Name, Student ID, email*. You can also use **Upload CSV**. Every student gets a random 6-character code. Add emails if you want BoutCasts to email the codes for you.
3. **Look at what students will see.** Press **View poll** next to Edit. It opens the real voting page. Tap **Start voting** with nothing typed in. Nothing you do in the preview is saved or counted.
4. **Open voting.** Press **Open voting** on the election page (it says **Pay and open voting** if your plan has a price).

Getting codes to students

- **Email:** in the **Vote by link** panel, press **Email codes to students**. Every student with an email gets the link and their own code. Use **Email everyone again** to send the codes once more.
- **Hand out:** press **Download roster with codes** and print it. Give each student their own code. Never post the list in public.
- **Share the link:** press **Copy link**. It is one school-wide link. Put it in an announcement or your school app. The link alone is not enough to vote. A student also needs a code.

What students do

1. Open the link.
2. Type their code and their first and last name, as it appears on the class list.
3. Pick one candidate for each office and press **Lock in my vote**. A vote cannot be changed once locked.
4. Students can leave and come back later to finish the offices they skipped, until voting closes. Results stay hidden while voting is open.

While voting is open

- Watch turnout under **Roster and turnout**. It shows how many students have voted.
- A student gets one vote per office. A student who already voted at a booth cannot vote again by link.

- After several wrong codes in a row, the sender is blocked for about 10 minutes. This protects against guessing. Ask the student to check their code and wait.
- Lost a code? Look the student up on the roster and give them the same code again.

When voting ends

1. Voting stops by itself at the closing time. To stop sooner, press **Close voting now**.
2. Review turnout and results. Tick the box that says you reviewed them, then press **Certify the results**.
3. Press **Print the certificate** or **View winners graphic** to share the winners.

Good to know
• Want to rehearse? Make a practice election. Use **Reset practice** to clear the votes and run it again.
• Need to fix a candidate name or photo? Press **Edit**. Offices and candidates lock once voting opens, but wording and photos can be fixed.
• Need help? Email **Support@boutcasts.com**.

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